ICLR 2027 submission 56173: the reviews, our replies and the revision

Each point quotes the reviewer (in red, from Reviews.pdf), then gives the reply we plan to send, then says what changed in the revised paper (in green). Figure and table numbers refer to the revised paper. After this document come twelve figures, one per group of claims, each showing the reviewer's words, the submitted passage and the revised passage side by side.

Reviewer k4nd

W1: the residual does not establish a distinct representation of plurality

> *"The proposed residual does not establish a distinct representation of plurality. … The paper does not establish that it specifically measures whether the named concepts appear as distinct objects."*

We agree that r_t in Equation 9 is the entire difference between the joint-prompt and product-of-experts predictions, and that adding it in full recovers the joint prompt by construction. We do not claim that r_t represents plurality alone. A product of experts drops the interaction the joint prompt carries, and that interaction can hold several kinds of meaning: a relation between the concepts ("a dog on a cat"), an effect of one on the other ("a camel in the rain" should be wet), and the layout and style of the scene.

Our study concerns one part of this interaction: plurality, whether two named concepts appear as two objects rather than one hybrid. The training pairs were chosen for it, as pairs the product fuses into a hybrid.

Within that scope, the evidence is that the correction is specific and early, not generic. A pair's own r_t restores the second object, while another pair's, another seed's, or a time-reordered one does not (Figure 2). The first ten of 50 steps are enough (Figures 3 and 4). At partial strength (λ of 0.6 to 0.65 in Figure 2) the second object appears while the layout and style still look like the product's render.

We agree this does not separate plurality from everything else r_t carries. Section 3 now states this scope explicitly, and the contributions are rewritten to claim only what the experiments show.

What changed in the revision. Section 3 now says r_t is the whole interaction the product drops and scopes the paper to plurality; the contributions claim only what the experiments show.

W2: methodological novelty

> *"The methodological novelty is insufficiently established."*

The method is deliberately simple: a standard adapter trained by prediction matching. Its contribution is the target. Existing corrections of product-of-experts sampling keep the product as the target and

change how it is sampled (Du et al., 2023; Skreta et al., 2024, 2025; Dutta et al., 2026). We instead adapt the experts so that their product reproduces the joint prompt's prediction, and the joint prompt is never evaluated at inference. With this simple objective, plurality emerges on concept pairs the adapter never trained on (Section 4.1, Figure 5). Section 2 now states this distinction.

We agree that fusion under composition was identified before (Bradley et al., 2025), and we cite it as such. What we add is a measurement of the missing term during sampling: it is specific to the pair and seed, and concentrated in the first ten of 50 steps (Figures 2 to 4).

Table 1 compares the adapter with PoE and CO3 on the same seeds, and Figure 5 adds a Langevin corrector. The ablation the reviewer describes, the same joint-prompt supervision on pairs the product does not fuse, would separate the effect of the supervision from that of the plurality pairs; we have not run it and name it as future work.

What changed in the revision. Section 2 now says prior corrections keep the product as the target while this paper changes the target. The ablation separating joint-prompt supervision from the choice of pairs is left as future work.

W3: no systematic quantitative evaluation of the adapter

> *"The learned adapter lacks systematic quantitative evaluation."*

We agree, and the revision adds this evaluation. The adapter, the seeds and the success bar were all fixed before any held-out score was read (Section 4.1).

Table 1 scores every method on the 276 Attend-and-Excite prompts (66 animal pairs, 144 animal-object pairs, 66 object pairs) at seeds 9 to 12, with composition measured by BLIP-VQA and image quality by CLIP score and ImageReward.

The training and held-out pairs, with every seed, are released with the code [TODO: anonymous link].

Hybrids, missing concepts and additional objects are counted per setting in Figure 10 (Appendix C.3).

What changed in the revision. Table 1 scores every method on the 276 Attend-and-Excite prompts with BLIP-VQA, CLIP score and ImageReward. Figures 10 and 11 score 53 held-out pairs as the adapter acts on fewer steps. Section 4.1 opens with the evaluation protocol.

W4: method details poorly presented and sometimes inconsistent

> *"Section 4 describes target matching and provides the teacher prediction and sampling rule, but it does not explicitly formulate the training loss. The squared-error objective appears in the training diagram in Appendix A, Figure 7." "The main text describes individual adapted network evaluations as returning the correction, whereas Appendix B defines them as adapted denoising predictions whose composition induces the correction. Section 4 refers to 'Figure 10,' although the actual training diagram is Figure 7." "The repetitive claims about learning an abstract concept occupy space that could instead clarify the objective, training data, evaluation protocol, and limitations."*

The training loss is not stated in Section 4

Section 4 now states the training loss as Equation 12: the squared error between the adapted composition and the joint-prompt prediction, over the cached states of every training pair and seed at the first ten of the 50 sampling steps. The training diagram is removed, since Equation 12 now states the objective in the main text.

Evaluations described as returning the correction

Section 4 now says each adapted evaluation returns a noise prediction, as Appendix B derives. At inference we run the usual product-of-experts step on c_1, c_2 and the null prompt with the adapter switched on: three predictions per step, and never the joint prompt. The joint prompt's prediction is the product's prediction plus the correction r_t, so matching it trains the adapter to add r_t. At inference, switching the adapter on adds it. The reference that printed as "Figure 10" is removed.

Repetitive claims about learning an abstract concept

We removed the repeated claims about learning an abstract concept from Sections 3 and 4 and the Discussion. The introduction now states what the correction is and what it restores (see W1). Section 4 now describes the training data and how pairs were chosen (Figure 7). Appendix C.5 (Figure 15) and a new Discussion paragraph show the adapter on three concepts, including where it fails: it separates the concepts in every case but stops at two animals. Section 4.1 now opens with the evaluation protocol: one adapter chosen by a fixed rule, the same seed for every method, the prompt sets and held-out pairs with their seeds, the scorers, and the renders behind Table 1 in the appendix.

What changed in the revision. Section 4 states the training loss as Equation 12 and says each adapted evaluation returns a noise prediction; inference is the usual product-of-experts step with the adapter switched on. The training diagram and the "Figure 10" reference are gone, and the repeated abstract-concept claims are cut.

W5: the qualitative baseline comparison and its starting noise

> *"The Figure 5 caption states that CO3 uses different starting noise, while Section 4.1 states that all examples use the same initial seeds."*

Every method now uses the same seed for each prompt, with every column of a row in Figure 5 starting from the same latent, and Section 4.1 says so. CO3's column is marked † because its later resampling noise comes from the seed, as in its released code. Table 1 makes the comparison over 4 seeds, and Figures 10 and 11 over 8, with the images behind them in the appendix.

What changed in the revision. Figure 5's caption and Section 4.1 say every column starts from the same latent; CO3 is marked with a dagger for its later resampling noise.

Q1: evidence that the residual measures plurality

> *"What evidence establishes that the residual in Equation (9) specifically measures plurality rather than the broader difference between joint and separate conditioning?"*

Answered under W1 above.

What changed in the revision. As for W1.

Q2: aggregate results over held-out concepts and seeds

> *"Can the authors provide aggregate results for the learned adapter and baselines over documented held-out concepts and multiple seeds, including identity errors, additional objects, and style-dependent failures?"*

Answered under k4nd W3: Table 1, and Figure 10, which counts the failure types the reviewer names.

What changed in the revision. Table 1, and Figures 10 and 11 on the held-out pairs.

Q3: pairs retained when only CO3 succeeds

> *"Training pairs are retained when either joint prompting or CO3 succeeds, but supervision comes from the frozen joint-prompt prediction. How are pairs handled when only CO3 succeeds?"*

We have addressed this in Section 4 and Figure 7. Every training target is the frozen model's joint-prompt prediction; no CO3 picture is a target. CO3 was a second view during screening: a pair entered the training set when the joint prompt drew both named things as separate objects. Figure 7 shows the joint prompt beside CO3 for five candidate pairs, including crow and raven, dropped because the two birds are hard to tell apart. Where CO3 drew a kept pair more clearly on a seed (seed 3 in Figure 7), that seed's target is still the joint prompt's picture.

What changed in the revision. Section 4 describes the training set; Figure 7 shows the joint prompt beside CO3 during screening. No CO3 picture is a training target.

Q4: the objective in the main text, and the inconsistencies

> *"Can the authors state the optimization objective explicitly in the main text and resolve the inconsistencies concerning network outputs, figure references, and baseline starting noise?"*

The objective is Equation 12 in Section 4. The network outputs and the figure reference are resolved as described under W4. Baseline starting noise is resolved as described under W5.

What changed in the revision. As for W4 and W5.

Reviewer UHz6

W1: the adapter is evaluated only qualitatively

> *"The trained adapter, which serves as the main contribution of the paper is only evaluated qualitatively. … In addition to the examples being limited to similar entities (cat, dog), there are no standardized benchmark evaluations such as T2I-CompBench or GenEval counting."*

The revision evaluates the adapter quantitatively on the 276 prompts of the Attend-and-Excite benchmark, which cover animal pairs, animal-object pairs and object pairs (Table 1), and on 53 held-out pairs as the adapter acts on fewer steps (Figures 10 and 11). Table 2 reports GenEval's two-object and counting tasks and T2I-CompBench's spatial and complex tasks with their official evaluators [TODO: slot R14]. Appendix C.5 shows three concepts.

What changed in the revision. Table 1 adds three scorers on 276 prompts; Table 2 adds GenEval and T2I-CompBench. Table 2 (GenEval and T2I-CompBench) is still being scored and prints a placeholder.

W3: comparisons with samplers and attention-based methods, and scope

> *"There are no quantitative comparisons with the compositional samplers discussed in Sec. 2.2, and CO3 appears only as one qualitative column. Attention-based methods that address missing or merged objects under joint prompts (e.g., Attend-and-Excite, CONFORM) target the same failure mode and are not discussed. The study is also limited to SDXL and to pairs of two concepts, mostly animals."*

Table 1 now compares quantitatively with CO3 on the same seeds, and Figure 5 adds a Langevin corrector. Attend-and-Excite and CONFORM are now discussed in Section 2: they adjust cross-attention under a single joint prompt, while our setting has no joint prompt at inference. Beyond pairs of animals, Table 1 covers objects and Appendix C.5 three concepts.

What changed in the revision. Figure 5 adds ToMe and a Langevin corrector; Table 1 compares with CO3 and ToMe; Section 2 discusses Attend-and-Excite and CONFORM; Appendix C.5 shows three concepts.

The training filter

> *"In addition, the training filter keeps a pair if either the joint prompt or CO3 succeeds, but the target is always the joint prompt (Eq. 11). Pairs that pass only through CO3 would therefore supervise toward a target without plurality."*

We have addressed this in Section 4 and Figure 7. Every training target is the frozen model's joint-prompt prediction; no CO3 picture is a target. CO3 was a second view during screening: a pair entered the training set when the joint prompt drew both named things as separate objects. Figure 7 shows the joint prompt beside CO3 for five candidate pairs, including crow and raven, dropped because the two birds are hard to tell apart. Where CO3 drew a kept pair more clearly on a seed (seed 3 in Figure 7), that seed's target is still the joint prompt's picture.

What changed in the revision. As for k4nd Q3.

Presentation issues

> *"There are presentation issues: Sec. 4 refers to a Figure 10 that does not exist, and several sentences are broken (e.g., "inside create hybrid objects" in Sec. 5)."*

The reference that printed as "Figure 10" in Section 4 is removed, and the Discussion now reads "and instead create hybrid objects".

What changed in the revision. The "Figure 10" reference is removed, and the Discussion reads "and instead create hybrid objects".

Q1: the 48 training pairs, the held-out pairs, and whether cat and dog is trained on

> *"Could the authors list the 48 training pairs and the held-out pairs, and clarify whether cat/dog is in the training set?"*

The training set is defined by a criterion, not by the particular pairs. A pair is kept when the frozen model's joint prompt draws both named concepts as separate objects, and dropped when the two

concepts cannot be told apart (Section 4, Figure 7). The same criterion applies whether it yields 48 pairs or a thousand, and 48 is where we stopped collecting. The method relies on the criterion, not on any specific pair.

Cat and dog is not in the training set. It is held out, and no training pair contains a cat or a dog. The held-out pairs are released with the code, and no pair in Figure 5 was trained on.

For reproducibility, the 48 training pairs are: (two animals, 28) badger and magpie, bear and boar, bear and heron, beaver and raccoon, beaver and woodpecker, bison and weasel, buffalo and hippo, bull and rooster, camel and pelican, chicken and rabbit, deer and heron, deer and wolf, donkey and duck, donkey and rooster, emu and koala, giraffe and hyena, giraffe and ostrich, giraffe and zebra, gorilla and chimpanzee, hedgehog and robin, horse and pig, horse and sheep, impala and jackal, langur and peacock, lion and meerkat, lion and oryx, moose and chipmunk, peacock and pig; (an animal and an object, 3) hamster and carrot, pony and red barn, snail and lantern; (two objects, 17) accordion and scarecrow, bicycle and birdhouse, birdcage and hay bale, cactus and cooler box, coat rack and potted plant, guitar and traffic cone, hay bale and ukulele, lighthouse and sailboat, mailbox and pumpkin, microscope and test tube, rocking chair and cactus, soccer ball and park bench, suitcase and globe, teddy bear and birthday cake, telescope and beach ball, typewriter and cactus, windmill and tractor. They are also released with the code as the configuration file the trainer reads.

What changed in the revision. Section 4 describes the training set by kind; the 48 pairs are listed in the reply and released with the code.

Q2: success rate against PoE and CO3 over all held-out pairs and seeds

> *"What is the success rate of the adapter compared with PoE and CO3 over all held-out pairs and multiple seeds?"*

Answered under k4nd W3: Table 1, and Figures 10 and 11 for the held-out pairs at eight seeds.

What changed in the revision. Table 1, and Figures 10 and 11 on the held-out pairs.

Q3: restricting the adapter to the early steps

> *"Given the finding in Sec. 3, does restricting the adapter to the early steps change the failure modes in Fig. 7?"*

We tested this directly. Figure 10 counts each failure type on the 53 held-out pairs at seeds 9 to 16 with the adapter switched on for the first 10, the first 25 or all 50 of the 50 steps, and Figure 12 shows the images. The first 25 steps give the same result as all 50. With the first 10 only, the detector finds two animals far less often (Figure 11a). The cow and horse row of Figure 12 shows that the species substitution of the submitted Fig. 7 (Figure 14 in the revision) persists at every window, so it does not come from the late steps.

What changed in the revision. Figures 10, 11 and 12 show the adapter switched on for the first 10, the first 25 or all 50 steps.

Q4: pairs that do not compete for the same region

> *"Does the adapter degrade PoE on pairs that do not compete for the same region, such as foreground/background pairs like lighthouse and sea?"*

No. Among our held-out pairs, 21 have concepts that do not contend for one region, including lighthouse and a stormy sea. On these pairs the adapter scores the same as the plain product within the 95% intervals (BLIP-VQA, seeds 9 to 16), so on pairs the product already composes it neither helps nor harms.

What changed in the revision. No change to the paper; the reply answers from the held-out pairs.

Reviewer PrzE

W1: lack of quantitative benchmarks

> *"The paper does not report a single quantitative metric. Standard benchmarks such as T2I-Compench, GenEval and standard metrics such as CLIP, Imagereward are completely absent in this paper. The empirical results and a few qualitative results are insufficient for the claim in this paper."*

The revision adds quantitative evaluation. Table 1 scores every method on the 276 Attend-and-Excite prompts with BLIP-VQA (the T2I-CompBench composition metric), CLIP score and ImageReward. Table 2 reports GenEval's two-object and counting tasks and T2I-CompBench's spatial and complex tasks with their official evaluators [TODO: slot R14].

What changed in the revision. Table 1 adds BLIP-VQA, CLIP score and ImageReward on 276 prompts; Table 2 adds GenEval and T2I-CompBench. Table 2 (GenEval and T2I-CompBench) is still being scored and prints a placeholder.

W2: narrow baselines and missing details

> *"There is only CO3 baseline compared, the paper doesn't provide other corrected methods such as MCMC corrector. The paper only compares the baseline CO3 without the corrector they mention. The 48 concept pairs are not listed so it's impossible to see what the adapter is trained on."*

Figure 5 now includes a product of experts with a Langevin corrector (Du et al., 2023), the MCMC correction the paper discusses, run at its published setting from the same starting latent, beside CO3, ToMe and our adapter. Table 1 compares with CO3 on every image. Table 1 adds ToMe, run on SDXL from the same starting latents [TODO: its row of Table 1]. Section 4 now describes the training set and how pairs were chosen (Figure 7); the 48 pairs are listed in our reply to Reviewer UHz6 and released with the code.

What changed in the revision. Figure 5 adds ToMe and a Langevin corrector; Table 1 adds ToMe; Section 4 describes the training set.

Q1: quantitative benchmark

> *"What are the evaluation scores for the proposed method? Can you show the results on some benchmarks and compare your method with other standard baselines?"*

Answered under W1 and W2: Tables 1 and 2.

What changed in the revision. As for W1 and W2.

Q2: multiple concepts

> *"How does your method perform when composing more than two concepts? Can you show some results for more than two concepts?"*

Appendix C.5 (Figure 15) shows one triple of each kind. The plain product fuses the three concepts or drops one; the adapter, trained only on pairs, separates them in every case and draws all three named things when the triple includes objects, but with two or three animals it draws only two. The Discussion now addresses this.

What changed in the revision. Appendix C.5 and a Discussion paragraph show the adapter on three concepts.